HAIR LOSS 07

Fluocinolone

Fluocinolone acetonide, a corticosteroid (anti-inflammatory steroid) used on the skin and scalp



CLASS
Topical corticosteroid

STUDIED FOR
Inflamed skin, scalp psoriasis

HUMAN EVIDENCE
FDA approved; no hair-loss studies

US STATUS
FDA approved (Synalar, Derma-Smoothe/FS)

STUDIED FOR

Scalp psoriasis
HUMAN

Inflamed skin
HUMAN

Hair loss is off-label. A PubMed search found no published study of fluocinolone for pattern hair loss.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Fluocinolone ▶ Steroid receptor ▶ Immune signals ▶ Less inflammation

- **Corticosteroids** act on cell signaling, immune function and inflammation
- **Precise mechanism** in scalp psoriasis is unknown, per the label
- **Absorbed steroid** can suppress the body's stress-hormone (HPA) axis
- **For hair loss,** no mechanism has been studied

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- Synalar approved in 1963
- Scalp oil: 60% vs 21% cleared or excellent at 21 days
- No published pattern hair-loss study

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Any use for pattern hair loss
- Long-term scalp use

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
Not established (not on the label)

ROUTES STUDIED
On the skin and scalp (ointment, solution, oil)

PHARMACOKINETICS
Absorbed through skin; liver metabolism, kidney excretion

SOLD AS
Prescription topical products (Synalar, Derma-Smoothe/FS, generics)

MONITORED IN TRIALS
HPA axis suppression, eyes (glaucoma, cataract), skin

SPORT (WADA)
Skin use not prohibited; class S9 bans some routes in competition

REGULATORY

FDA Approved for skin, scalp conditions; not hair loss

FDA Compounded hair sprays are not FDA approved

WADA S9: injected, oral, rectal use banned in competition

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Derma-Smoothe/FS Scalp Oil prescribing information (DailyMed), May 2025
2. FDA, Fluocinolone acetonide topical solution label (DailyMed), Feb 2026
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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